

Trump: early financing

Trace Trump's early casino financing, Rothschild Inc.'s creditor-side role, Wilbur Ross and the records needed to test later institutional involvement.

PUBLISHED WEEKLY RECORD THROUGH 2026-08-30 • STRUCTURED RESEARCH
REVIEWED 2026-09-08

In the full report

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These links open the preserved report, including its dated evidence and qualifications.

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Evidence & context

DOCUMENTED RECORD • COURT ACCOUNT OF PROSPECTUS FINANCING

The 1992 federal securities opinion records a \$75 million capital contribution by Donald Trump to the Taj partnership and identifies Merrill Lynch as the 1988 bond underwriter.

The reproduced prospectus table lists \$675 million in bond proceeds, \$75 million in capital and \$55 million from other sources. The opinion's opening background instead says \$674 million; that source discrepancy is retained. The court says Trump made the required contribution and was not a personal guarantor of the Taj's success. This does not resolve every separate debt or guarantee.

EVENT OR SCHEDULED DATE: 1988-11-09 • SOURCE REVIEW: 2026-09-08

U.S. District Court for the District of New Jersey; Justia mirror: In re Donald J. Trump Casino Securities Litigation, 793 F. Supp. 543

PUBLICATION DATE NOT RECORDED • REVIEWED 2026-09-08

LOCATION: 793 F. SUPP. 543; MDL 864 (JFG); CIV. A. NO. 90-0919; PROSPECTUS DATED NOV. 9, 1988; HTML LINES 73-78, 195-211, 258-271, 361-383

A 1993 bankruptcy opinion records that Trump Taj Mahal Associates and three affiliated corporate debtors filed Chapter 11 petitions on 16 July 1991; the court confirmed their plan on 28 August 1991.

The named affiliates were Trump Taj Mahal, Inc., The Trump Taj Mahal Corporation and Trump Taj Mahal Funding, Inc. These are entity bankruptcies. This opinion supplies the filing and confirmation dates; it does not establish every creditor's role, final distribution or a personal Trump bankruptcy.

EVENT OR SCHEDULED DATE: 1991-07-16 · SOURCE REVIEW: 2026-09-08

U.S. Bankruptcy Court for the District of New Jersey; CaseMine mirror: In re Trump Taj Mahal Associates, 156 B.R. 928

PUBLICATION DATE NOT RECORDED · REVIEWED 2026-09-08

LOCATION: 156 B.R. 928; BANKRUPTCY NOS. 91-13321, 91-13325, 91-13351, 91-13334; ADV. NO. 93-2056; FACTS PARAGRAPHS REPRODUCED AT HTML LINES 107-118

DOCUMENTED RECORD · CORROBORATED CONTEMPORARY REPORTING

Contemporary UPI and Washington Post reporting identifies Wilbur Ross of Rothschild Inc. as a Taj bondholder representative. TIME independently reports the firm's creditor role in the 1991 bankruptcy.

Together these establish a corroborated reporting record of creditor-side negotiation and restructuring work. The contemporaneous UPI announcement describes preliminary terms; it is not the final confirmed plan. The engagement agreement, creditor-committee appointment and fee order remain records to retrieve. A personal loan from a Rothschild family member, or continuing institutional control, is not established by these reports.

EVENT OR SCHEDULED DATE: 1990-11-16 · SOURCE REVIEW: 2026-09-08

United Press International: Trump's Taj Mahal casino to enter consensual bankruptcy

1990-11-16 · REVIEWED 2026-09-08

LOCATION: INDEXED ARTICLE TEXT NAMING ROSS AS A KEY NEGOTIATOR AND DESCRIBING ANNOUNCED TERMS

The Washington Post: Speculators Are Enjoying the Spectacle of Trump's Taj Mahal Troubles

1990-11-12 · REVIEWED 2026-09-08

LOCATION: DISPLAYED DATE NOV. 12, 1990; HTML LINES 19-28

TIME: Wall Street: The Dealers Return

1991-09-16 · REVIEWED 2026-09-08

LOCATION: OPENING ARTICLE PASSAGE

[Read the preceding record](#)

DOCUMENTED RECORD · ISSUER-FILED BIOGRAPHICAL ACCOUNT

A 2005 SEC-filed Mittal Steel biography identifies Wilbur L. Ross as a former executive managing director of Rothschild Inc., with that employment ending in March 2000, and as CEO of WL Ross & Co. from April 2000.

This issuer-filed biography supports Ross's identity and the employment boundary. His later roles cannot automatically be attributed to his former employer. An institutional, ownership or financial continuation needs a separate dated record. The early-finance packet also identified differing historical

start years in a later Senate questionnaire; that discrepancy does not change the shared 1990 employment interval.

EVENT OR SCHEDULED DATE: NOT RECORDED · SOURCE REVIEW: 2026-09-08

Mittal Steel Company N.V., filed through U.S. SEC EDGAR: Mittal Steel Company N.V. Shareholders Circular dated March 14, 2005

2005-03-14 · REVIEWED 2026-09-08

LOCATION: EXHIBIT 99.1.1 TO FORM 6-K, ACCESSION 0000950123-05-003084; WILBUR L. ROSS BIOGRAPHICAL PARAGRAPH

DOCUMENTED RECORD · OFFICIAL APPOINTMENT RECORD

The Senate confirmed Wilbur L. Ross Jr. as Secretary of Commerce on 27 February 2017 by 72–27. The archived White House biography records his swearing-in the next day and his role in the Trump administration.

This is a documented personnel bridge from Trump’s earlier creditor negotiations to his first administration when read alongside the separately dated Ross employment and Taj records. It does not establish that Rothschild Inc. directed the appointment or continued a financing or advisory role.

EVENT OR SCHEDULED DATE: 2017-02-28 · SOURCE REVIEW: 2026-09-08

United States Senate: U.S. Senate Roll Call Vote 73, confirmation of Wilbur L. Ross, Jr. to be Secretary of Commerce

2017-02-27 · REVIEWED 2026-09-08

LOCATION: NOMINATION PN32; VOTE 73; CONFIRMED 72-27 ON 2017-02-27

Trump White House, archived by the National Archives: Wilbur L. Ross, Jr. — Secretary of Commerce

PUBLICATION DATE NOT RECORDED · REVIEWED 2026-09-08

LOCATION: BIOGRAPHY OPENING; SWORN-IN DATE, OFFICE, TRUMP ADMINISTRATION ROLE, AND PRIOR WL ROSS & CO. ROLE

Open questions

1. Which legal entities represented lenders or creditors in each restructuring?
2. Which named Rothschild entities or individuals, if any, appear in later verified financing, ownership or advisory records?
3. What do bankruptcy plans and creditor appointments establish beyond contemporary reporting?

Explore connections

[Open this topic in the map →](#)

[Follow dated connection paths →](#)

Related entities

Entities associated with this research topic; this list does not assert a relationship between them.

- [THE PRINCIPAL](#)
- [Wilbur Ross](#)
- [Rothschild Inc.](#)
- [Taj Associates](#)
- [Taj bondholders](#)
- [Merrill Lynch](#)
- [Taj Funding Inc.](#)

Research history

Topic opened 2026-09-08; updated 2026-09-08.

- 2026-09-08 · Evidence review · reject: Creditor representation, professional fees, lending, ownership and later public appointments are distinct relations. Trace intermediaries without converting one role into another or interpreting a failed archive fetch as absence.
- 2026-09-08 · Evidence review · reject: Normalize incoming source origins against the existing registry before admission. Different article dates, author labels or packet-local origin names do not create independent outlets; repeated UPI stories remain one origin.

▼ Superseded records

SUPERSEDED · RETAINED HISTORY · CONTEMPORARY REPORTING

Contemporary UPI reporting identifies Wilbur Ross of Rothschild Inc. as a negotiator for Taj Mahal bondholders during the announced 1990 restructuring.

This is a research lead pending original bankruptcy and creditor records. The reporting describes a creditor-side role and earlier rejection of Trump's offer; it does not establish a personal family loan or continuing involvement.

EVENT OR SCHEDULED DATE: 1990-11-16 · SOURCE REVIEW: 2026-09-08

UPI: Trump's Taj Mahal casino to enter consensual bankruptcy

1990-11-17 · REVIEWED 2026-09-08

UPI: Bondholders reject Trump offer

1990-10-16 · REVIEWED 2026-09-08

Read the replacement record

How this record grows. The topic registry supplies these pages and the map filters. New evidence can suggest topics; recorded review accepts or rejects those suggestions. A source establishes only what it actually records. Historical editions and superseded claims remain accessible.